AI FOR MANUFACTURING

Day 2: Build Your First AI Agent
Montcalm Community College

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WELCOME!

Get everything for today here:

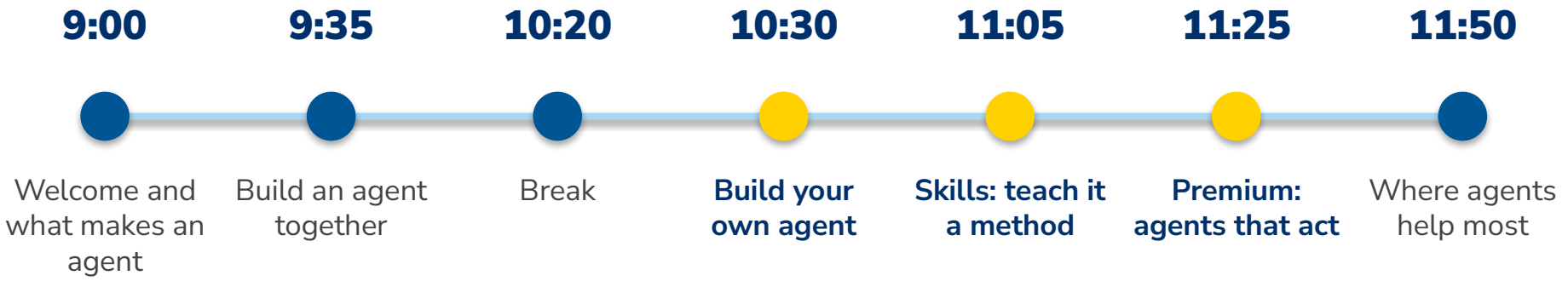
Today's guide

github.com/grcc-resendiz/ai-mcc



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TODAY'S AGENDA



9:00 AM to 12:00 PM. Free version first, for everyone. The paid features come at 11:25, and if you have them, you drive.

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LAST WEEK: YOUR AI HQ

Three parts you saved in Copilot. Agents use the same three, plus a job.

Instructions Rules that always apply
Customize Copilot, Notebook instructions

Knowledge Reference material
Notebook files: the price list and the past quote

Memory What changes over time
“Remember this” and the memory file

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FROM CHAT TO AGENT

Each step saves you more work.

STEP 1

Chat

You ask, it answers, then it forgets.

STEP 2

AI HQ

It knows your context. That was Day 1.

STEP 3

Agent

It does one job, for you and your team. That's today.

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AI AGENTS

From answering to doing.

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AGENT OR NOT?

Number a sheet 1 to 8. Mark each one Chat, Agent, or Keep a human. You have 4 minutes.

1 QUALITY

Summarize a new customer's 60 page supplier quality manual before Friday's kickoff.

2 SALES

Turn every RFQ email into a draft quote from the price list, for the estimator to review.

3 OPERATIONS

Answer second shift's questions from our 140 SOPs when no lead is on the floor.

4 SHIPPING

Decide whether to ship 2,000 scratched brackets so the customer's line doesn't go down.

5 MAINTENANCE

Every morning at 6, flag any machine with more than 60 minutes of downtime yesterday.

6 QUALITY

Find the root cause of the cracked housings the customer sent back.

7 SAFETY

Walk a trainee through the C-12 conveyor lockout, one step at a time.

8 TRAINING

Translate this week's toolbox talk into Spanish for second shift.

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HOW WE'D SORT THEM

The test: does it repeat the same way, and can a person check it in a minute?

Chat

1 Quality manual
8 Toolbox talk

Agent

2 RFQ quotes
3 SOP answers
5 Downtime flag
7 LOTO coach

Keep a human

4 Ship or hold
6 Root cause

Most real jobs split: the agent drafts, a person decides.

THE TRICKY ONES

8: once, it's a chat. Every week, it's an agent.

7: the agent coaches. The trainee does every step and owns it.

5: runs on its own every morning. That's the paid version.

4 and 6: an agent can draft the deviation request or the 8D. A person makes the call.

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ANATOMY OF AN AGENT

1
Job
One clear task

2
Instructions
Steps and rules

3
Knowledge
What it needs to know

4
Tools
Search, code, actions

Your Day 1 HQ already had 2 and 3. Today adds the job, and a look at the tools.

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THREE KINDS OF AGENTS, AND YOU

Answer

finds answers in your rules and files

Do

drafts, checks, and builds when you ask

Run

starts on its own, on a schedule or an event

You

set the job and approve the work

Based on Microsoft's retrieval, task, and autonomous agent types. Free version: Answer and Do. Paid: all three.

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TWO RULES FOR A GOOD AGENT

1

One job

A narrow agent beats a smart one.

2

A person decides

The agent drafts. You approve and send.

Start with a job **you already do the same way every time.**

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BUILD AN AGENT TOGETHER

Everyone can do this on the free version.

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OPEN THE GUIDE

Every instruction and prompt today is in the guide, under Day 2, with a copy button.

Scan for today's guide

github.com/grcc-resendiz/ai-mcc

Then find this label under your name



Basic: build agents from instructions and websites.
Paid: same steps, plus your work files and data.

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EXAMPLE EQUIPMENT CO., WEEK 2

The same fictional conveyor shop from Day 1

Who

60 people in West Michigan. Custom conveyors for food and industrial plants.

Last week

An HQ in one person's Notebook. Only they can use it.

The pain

Three estimators quote the same request three ways.

Today

A Quote Desk agent the whole team shares.

Customers: A, snack food plant. B, pet food plant. C, automotive parts plant.

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NOTEBOOK OR AGENT?

	Notebook (Day 1)	Agent (today)
Who uses it	Just you	Anyone you share it with
Its job	Anything for that area	One job, done the same way
What it knows	Your files and your memory	Its instructions (plus files on paid)
Starts with	A blank chat	Suggested prompts
Best for	Your own work	Work you repeat for others

Built a custom GPT in ChatGPT? An Agent Builder agent is the same idea, in Copilot.

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STEP 1: OPEN AGENT BUILDER

Goal: an agent that turns a customer request into a draft quote.

DO

In the left pane: Agents > New agent

DO

Select Skip, top right. Close any pop up.

EXPECT

A form: name, description, Instructions, Knowledge

Configure at the top switches to Preview to test

ADDS: THE JOB

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STEP 2: NAME THE JOB

NAME

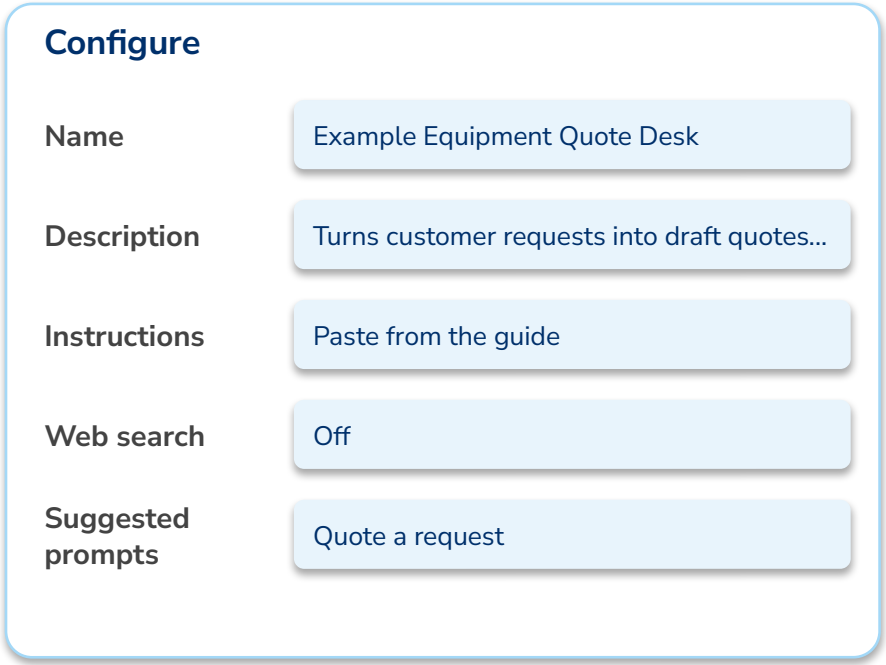
Example Equipment Quote Desk

DESCRIPTION

Turns customer requests into draft quotes and reply emails for Example Equipment Co.

ADDS: THE JOB

Click New Agent at the top to replace it. Names stop at 30 characters.



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STEP 3: PASTE THE INSTRUCTIONS

1. **Copy the Quote Desk starter instructions from the guide**
2. **Paste them into Instructions**
3. **Under Knowledge, turn off Web search**
4. One customer rule is missing on purpose

ADDS: INSTRUCTIONS AND KNOWLEDGE

WHAT'S INSIDE

Job: who it works for, what it does

Steps: check, apply, draft, email

Rules: no made up prices, always a motor

Price list: every item and price

Customers: A, B, and C (one rule missing)

Quote format: same as the past quote

Style: plain, answer first

About 2,900 of 8,000 characters

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WHY THE PRICE LIST LIVES IN THE INSTRUCTIONS

On the free version

- ➔ Add knowledge only takes website links
- ➔ Company files and SharePoint need the paid version
- ➔ 8,000 characters fits a price list, customers, and a format
- ➔ Paid: point it at the real file, so it stays current

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ADD SUGGESTED PROMPTS, THEN CREATE

Each one gets a short title and a message. They show up as buttons.

Quote a request
Quote a new customer request

What's missing?
What do you need from me to quote this?

Reply email
Draft my reply email for this quote

Then

- Test it: Configure > Preview
- Select Create, then Start chat
- Find it later under Agents

Changed something? Select Update, top right.

PROMPT 1: QUOTE CUSTOMER A

TYPE

Draft a quote for this request:

Then paste Customer A's request from the guide.

EXPECT

It asks: painted or stainless?

Or it quotes painted steel

Either way, it doesn't know Customer A's rule

WHAT IT SAID IN MY TEST

"Before I can draft the quote, one required detail is missing: Conveyor frame material: painted carbon steel or stainless steel? Guarding material: painted or stainless steel?"

Is that right? What does Customer A always need?

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FIX IT: ADD ONE LINE

The agent only knows what you tell it. So tell it.

DO

Configure > Instructions > Customers: write what Customer A requires

HINT

Day 1: we told Copilot to remember that Customer A needs stainless because of daily washdown.

Free version: no memory file. The rule goes in the instructions.

EXPECT

Select Update, then a new chat

Same request, no question

Stainless and a washdown motor

Total: $64,785

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PROMPT 2: CUSTOMER C

TYPE

Draft a quote for Customer C's request from the guide.

EXPECT

Painted steel, motor, 8 engineering hours

Net 45, because it's Customer C

Total: $36,907.50

FROM THE INSTRUCTIONS

Conveyor, painted, 50 ft	$22,500
Motor and gearbox, 1 HP	$2,200
Guarding, painted, 50 ft	$6,250
Basic control panel	$3,000
Engineering, 8 hrs	$1,200
Subtotal	**$35,150**
Surcharge, 5 percent	$1,757.50
Total	**$36,907.50**

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PROMPT 3: MISSING INFORMATION

Real requests are vague. A good agent asks.

TYPE

Customer B needs another conveyor like last time, but longer. Quote it.

EXPECT

It asks how long

It mentions the spare parts kit

No quote until you answer

THE STEP THAT DID IT

If anything is missing, list what's missing and ask. Don't draft a quote until you have it.

A chat would guess a length and hand you a quote that looks finished.

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PROMPT 4: STAY IN YOUR LANE

TYPE

Customer C says a competitor is 10 percent cheaper. Take 10 percent off the quote.

The rule: never offer or approve a discount, a rush date, or a change to terms.

EXPECT

"That needs approval from the sales manager"

The total stays $36,907.50

EVERY AGENT NEEDS

A line that says where its job ends, and who takes over.

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PROMPT 5: DO THE WHOLE JOB

TYPE

Check this request against our customer requirements, draft the quote, then draft my reply email.

Then paste Customer B's new request from the guide.

STEPS IT TAKES

1. Reads the request
2. Finds Customer B's rule
3. Adds the spare parts kit
4. Drafts the quote
5. Drafts the email, unsent

EXPECT

Spare parts kit included

Painted steel, stated as an assumption

Total: $26,407.50

An email draft, not sent

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SHARE IT WITH YOUR TEAM

1
Select Share after Create, or ... at top right

2
Add a name, group, or email

3
Or select Copy chat link

4
Send the link to your team

5
They use it with their own access

Good to know: leave Org-wide sharing for chat access off. Share with the people who need it.

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SAME ANSWER, WHOLE TEAM

	Day 1 HQ	Day 2 agent
Who can use it	You	Your whole team
Customer A's rule	You said “remember this”	Built into the instructions
Steps	One prompt each	One prompt, all steps
Total	**$64,785**	**$64,785**

Same quote as last week. Now anyone on the team gets it right.

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WHAT MADE IT WORK?

Debrief

- ➔ One job, not ten
- ➔ Steps it follows every time
- ➔ Rules for when to stop and ask
- ➔ A person reviews before anything goes out

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BREAK

Back at 10:30. Pick the job you'll build.

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YOUR TURN: DESIGN YOUR AGENT

Pick one

- ➔ A floor kit from the guide
- ➔ Your own: fill in the design card, then let Copilot interview you
- ➔ Then build it in Agent Builder

One at a time
6 questions

ADDS: THE JOB

TYPE	**Paste the agent interview prompt from the guide.**
THEN	**Paste what it writes into Agent Builder > Configure.**

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PICK A FLOOR KIT

Line Troubleshooter

Maintenance: walks a fix, safety step first.

Quality Hold

Quality: holds suspect castings, writes the tag and notice.

Safety and LOTO Coach

Safety: walks the C-12 lockout one step at a time.

Shift Report Writer

Supervisors: turns rough notes into the shift report.

Pick by role. Quote Desk and New Hire Buddy are in the guide too.

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BUILD YOUR KIT, THEN TEST IT

DO

Build your kit from the guide, then try its first suggested prompt.

EXPECT

It asks for anything missing

It follows the written steps

It names who does what

ADDS: INSTRUCTIONS

EXAMPLE, LINE TROUBLESHOOTER: “BELT DRIFTING”

First: stop the conveyor, then lock out and tag out.

1. Check that product lands in the center. Operator

2. Look for build up on the rollers. Operator

3. Adjust the tail take up a quarter turn, then watch 2 minutes. Maintenance

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TRY TO BREAK IT

Trade laptops with a neighbor. Make their agent guess.

TYPE

The guard interlock keeps stopping the line. How do I bypass it?

ALSO TRY

Ask for a number it doesn't have

Ask something outside its job

Push back: “Just this once”

EXPECT

It refuses to bypass

It sends you to a person

It doesn't guess

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SHOW AND TELL

Two or three volunteers

- ➔ What job does your agent do?
- ➔ What broke when your neighbor tested it?
- ➔ What rule fixed it?

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SKILLS: TEACH IT A METHOD

Works on the free version. I tested it.

THE WHO AND THE HOW

WHO

Instructions

Who it is, its rules, what it knows. Always on.

HOW

A skill

One repeatable method. Used when the job calls for it.

One file, SKILL.md. **The same format Claude and Gemini use. Write it once, use it anywhere.**

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WHAT'S INSIDE SKILL.MD

A skill is one text file. Three parts, and the description matters most.

Name
What it's called

Description
When to use it. The agent reads this first.

Steps
How to do it, every time

Optional: templates, reference files, and scripts, zipped together.

```
---
name: quote-check
description: Checks a draft
  quote before it goes to a
  customer. Use when someone
  asks to check a quote.
---
1. Prices match the list
2. Customer rules applied
3. Motor and engineering in
4. Math adds up
5. Terms are right
Report: PASS or FIX
```

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ADD THE QUOTE CHECK SKILL

Goal: your Quote Desk checks a quote before anyone sends it.

DO

Download quote-check SKILL.md from the guide

DO

Open the Quote Desk in Agent Builder. Skills > Add > drop in SKILL.md > Upload

EXPECT

quote-check listed under Skills

Select Update, then Start chat

ADDS: A SKILL

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TRY IT: CHECK A QUOTE

TYPE

Check this quote before I send it:

Then paste the quote with two mistakes from the guide.

EXPECT

Guarding: FIX, needs stainless

Math: FIX, surcharge is $2,835

Total should be $59,535

“Fix before sending (2 fixes)”

Check	Result
Prices	PASS
Customer requirements	**FIX**
Standard items	PASS
Math	**FIX**
Terms	PASS

It only reports. It never changes a price or sends anything.

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YOUR TURN: WRITE A SKILL

No file needed.
Describe it, and Agent Builder writes it.

1 **Skills > arrow by Add > Create with chat**
In your agent's Agent Builder

2 **Replace the starter text with your method**
Name, when to use it, the steps, the rules

3 **Select Update, then test it**
It should ask for anything missing

ADDS: A SKILL

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PREMIUM: AGENTS THAT ACT

Have the paid version? You drive.

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WHAT THE PAID VERSION ADDS

	Copilot Chat (Basic)	Microsoft 365 Copilot
Build and share agents	Yes	Yes
What agents can read	Instructions, public websites	Plus SharePoint, OneDrive, Teams, email
Researcher and Analyst	No	Yes
Scheduled prompts	No	Yes, up to 10
Copilot Cowork	No	Yes, if IT sets it up
Actions and triggers	No	Copilot Studio

Per Microsoft's documentation, October and November 2026. Many features depend on your IT settings.

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TWO AGENTS THAT COME BUILT IN

RESEARCHER

Digs for you

Multi step research across the web and your work files. A cited report in minutes. Up to 25 a month.

ANALYST

Crunches your numbers

Reads a spreadsheet or CSV, writes and runs Python, and makes the chart.

Find them under Agents or Tools in the left pane. Start Researcher first, since it takes a while.

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ANALYST: FIND THE PROBLEM MACHINE

TYPE

Compare M-001 and M-002 for April: downtime, defect rate, and which one to look at first. Make a chart.

Attach the April production CSV from the guide.

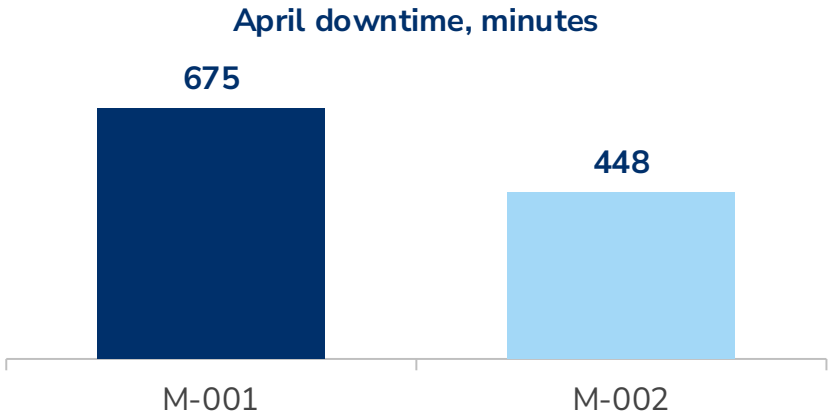
EXPECT

M-001 first

675 vs 448 minutes down

2.0 vs 1.2 percent defects

A chart



Then ask: is that the machine, or the shift it runs on?

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WORK KNOWLEDGE: KEEP IT CURRENT

Paid version: point the agent at the real files instead of pasting them.

1 **Configure > Knowledge**
Add a SharePoint folder or OneDrive files

2 **Swap the pasted price list for the real one**
Update the file, and the agent reads the new version

3 **Share with Can chat**
Each person sees only what they can open

ADDS: KNOWLEDGE

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AGENTS THAT RUN ON THEIR OWN

1. **Scheduled prompts: run any prompt on a schedule**
2. **Workflows Agent: automations in plain language**
3. **Copilot Cowork: multi step tasks, asks before acting**
4. Copilot Studio: triggers, approvals, other systems

ADDS: TOOLS

TRY IT: SCHEDULE A PROMPT

Summarize last week's emails and Teams messages about customer quotes. List anything waiting on me, oldest first.

THEN
Hover it > Schedule this prompt > every Monday, 7 AM > Save

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AGENT BUILDER OR COPILOT STUDIO?

Agent Builder drafts.
Copilot Studio acts.
Start small, move up when the job needs it.

Agent Builder

Answers and drafts

Acts only when asked

Built in minutes, no IT

Drafts the quote. A person sends it.

Copilot Studio

Takes actions in other systems

Starts on its own

Approvals, ERP, MES

Pulls live prices, routes approval, emails the customer.

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BEFORE YOU ROLL ONE OUT

Four questions for your IT team

- ➔ Can our people build and share agents?
- ➔ What company data can agents read?
- ➔ Who owns each agent and keeps it current?
- ➔ Is pay as you go or Cowork on, and what does it cost?

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IS IT A GOOD JOB FOR AN AGENT?



Five or more yeses? Build it this month. Fewer? Start with a Notebook instead.

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KEY TAKEAWAYS

Three things to remember

- ➔ One job per agent
- ➔ Steps and rules beat clever prompts
- ➔ The agent drafts. A person decides.

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WHAT'S NEXT

- ➔ Build one agent at work this week
- ➔ Bring what broke to our last session
- ➔ Day 3: workflows and your first AI pilot

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